

Daily Content Intel

August 5, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, so a meta-analysis just pulled 16 randomized trials, 16,029 adolescent team athletes, and asked what a prevention warm-up actually buys you.

Total injuries dropped 35%. Lower extremity, 33%. Ankles, 38%. Knees, 22%. And overuse injuries dropped 39%, which is the one I didn't expect, because these programs usually get sold as a cutting and landing solution.

Here's the part that should change how you run practice. The programs under 20 minutes beat the longer ones.

Shorter won. And the combination that carried the whole effect was warm-up, jumping, strength, agility, and balance,

all 5 of them running together.

So what does that look like Monday?

Take the jog and the stretching circle at the front of practice and put about 15 minutes in that slot. A few plyos, hamstring and core strength, some agility, some single leg balance. Same practice length, different first 15.

The authors rate the evidence quality as low, so I'd hold the exact percentages loosely. The direction has been the same for 20 years of this research though, and it costs you nothing to run.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: 15 minutes at the front of practice cuts your team's injuries by a third.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, so a meta-analysis just pulled 16 randomized trials, 16,029 adolescent team athletes, and asked what a prevention warm-up actually buys you.

Total injuries dropped 35%. Lower extremity, 33%. Ankles, 38%. Knees, 22%. And overuse injuries dropped 39%, which is the one I didn't expect, because these programs usually get sold as a cutting and landing solution.

Here's the part that should change how you run practice. The programs under 20 minutes beat the longer ones. Shorter won. And the combination that carried the whole effect was warm-up, jumping, strength, agility, and balance, all 5 of them running together.

So what does that look like Monday? Take the jog and the stretching circle at the front of practice and put about 15 minutes in that slot. A few plyos, hamstring and core strength, some agility, some single leg balance. Same practice length, different first 15.

The authors rate the evidence quality as low, so I'd hold the exact percentages loosely. The direction has been the same for 20 years of this research though, and it costs you nothing to run.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 15 minutes cuts injuries by a third
- 0:08 16 RCTs. 16,029 adolescent athletes.
- 0:16 Total injuries: down 35%
- 0:20 Ankles: down 38%
- 0:24 Knees: down 22%
- 0:29 Overuse: down 39%
- 0:42 Under 20 minutes beat the longer programs
- 0:50 Warm-up + jumping + strength + agility + balance
- 1:02 Monday: replace the jog and the stretch circle
- 1:15 Same practice length. Different first 15.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

15 minutes at the front of practice cuts your team's injuries by about a third.

A new meta-analysis in *Frontiers in Pediatrics* pooled 16 randomized trials and 16,029 adolescent team athletes. Total injuries dropped 35%. Lower extremity 33%,

ankles 38%, knees 22%. Overuse injuries dropped 39%, which is the number I keep re-reading, because these programs get pitched as a cutting and landing fix.

Two details decide whether it works for your team. Programs under 20 minutes outperformed the longer ones, and the effect came from the full combination: warm-up, jumping, strength, agility, and balance together.

Monday version: take the jog and the stretching circle at the front of practice and put 15 minutes there instead. A few plyos, hamstring and core strength, agility, single leg balance. Same practice length.

The authors rate the evidence quality as low, so hold the exact percentages loosely. The direction has held for 20 years, and it's free.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
threshold.clientsecure.me

#injuryprevention #warmup
#highschoolfootball #lacrosse
#footballtraining #strengthandconditioning

#youthsports #athletictraining #sportspt
#physicaltherapy #aclprevention
#anklesprain #coaching #sportsmedicine

Personalize this

- You program HS football. What does your actual first 15 minutes look like right now, and which of the 5 pieces (warm-up, jumping, strength, agility, balance) is missing from the teams you see? Name the one that always gets cut when practice runs late.
- Have you had a head coach or a club lacrosse program push back on giving you 15 minutes of practice time? How did you win that argument, or how did you lose it? That story is the whole Reel.
- The overuse number (39%) is the surprising one. Which of your athletes showed up with a chronic complaint (shin pain, patellar tendon, low back) that traced straight back to a season with no strength work? Use that case instead of the generic version.

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12819658/> | "Effects of multicomponent exercise injury prevention programs on adolescent team athletes (10–19 years old): a systematic review and meta-analysis"
- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12819658/> | "The results revealed that these programs significantly reduced injuries across various body regions: total injuries by 35%"
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12819658/> | "confirmed the optimal training duration (<20 min) as well as the most effective training combination (warm-up, jumping/plyometric, strength, agility, and balance training)"

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC12819658/>
- <https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/pediatrics/articles/10.3389/fped.2025.1561993/full>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. Your athlete has run 5 programs since January, and that is the reason they're not stronger.

There's a systematic review in the Journal of Strength and Conditioning Research that asked this exact question. 8 studies, 241 lifters, comparing people who kept the same exercises against people who rotated them.

The finding is pretty specific. Some systematic variation helps, it fills in the regions one exercise misses. And then the line that matters, and I'll read it: excessive, random variation may compromise muscular gains. The authors go further, they say a high frequency of change may actually hinder muscular adaptations.

I heard the same idea on Mike T Nelson's podcast this morning with Zach Moore, and it was the sharpest thing in the episode. Back when you found a workout in a book, you had no idea what results anybody else got from it, so you trusted it, you ran it, and you worked hard. That's most of the magic, right?

So here's my rule. Pick 4 main lifts, run them 8 to 12 weeks, and let the weight on the bar be the thing that moves. Keep the variety in the accessories, where it costs you nothing.

If your athlete can't tell you what their squat did since June, you already have your answer.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: Your athlete has run 5 programs since January. That's why they're not stronger.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. Your athlete has run 5 programs since January, and that is the reason they're not stronger.

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I heard the same idea on Mike T Nelson's podcast this morning with Zach Moore, and it was the sharpest thing in the episode. Back when you found a workout in a book, you had no idea what results anybody else got from it, so you trusted it, you ran it, and you worked hard. That's most of the magic, right?

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 5 programs since January
- 0:06 That's why they're not stronger
- 0:14 8 studies. 241 lifters. Same exercises vs. rotated.
- 0:26 Systematic variation: helps
- 0:32 "Excessive, random variation may compromise muscular gains"
- 0:42 High frequency of change hinders adaptation
- 0:56 Trust it. Run it. Work hard.
- 1:08 4 main lifts. 8 to 12 weeks.
- 1:14 Let the weight on the bar be the thing that moves
- 1:22 What did their squat do since June?

Caption (copy-paste ready):

Your athlete has run 5 programs since January. That's why they're not stronger.

A systematic review in the Journal of Strength and Conditioning Research looked at exactly this: 8 studies, 241 lifters, fixed exercise selection against rotating exercises. Some systematic variation helped, because different exercises fill in regions one lift misses. Then the authors wrote the sentence that matters: excessive, random variation may compromise muscular gains. A high frequency of change may actually hinder adaptation.

Mike T Nelson and Zach Moore hit the same point on the podcast this morning. Back when you found a workout in a book, you had no idea what anyone else got out of it, so you trusted it and ran it and worked hard. That's most of the magic.

My rule: pick 4 main lifts, run them 8 to 12 weeks, and let the weight on the bar be the thing that moves. Keep the variety in the accessories, where it costs you nothing.

If your athlete can't tell you what their squat did since June, you already have your answer.

It's time to cross your threshold.

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#strengthandconditioning
#progressiveoverload #highschoolfootball
#lacrosse #footballtraining
#offseasontraining #youthsports
#athleticperformance #weightroom
#strengthtraining #sportsscience #coaching
#sportspt #athletictraining

Personalize this

- Which 4 main lifts do you actually anchor a HS football offseason to, and how long do you hold them before anything changes? Say the real numbers, that's what separates this from every "just be consistent" Reel.
- Name a specific athlete who stalled because they kept swapping programs off social media, and what their squat or clean did once you made them run one

block start to finish. One athlete, one number.

- Your lacrosse athletes are in club season most of the year. What does "run it 8 to 12 weeks" look like when they're playing weekend tournaments, and how does that fit into CROSS?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/35438660/>
| "Does Varying Resistance Exercises Promote Superior Muscle Hypertrophy and Strength Gains? A Systematic Review"
- physiology | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/35438660/>
| "Some degree of systematic variation seems to enhance regional hypertrophic adaptations and maximize dynamic strength, whereas excessive, random variation may compromise muscular gains."
- actionable | <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/35438660/>
| "employing different exercises that

provide a redundant stimulus, as well as excessive rotation of different exercises (i.e., high frequency of change), may actually hinder muscular adaptations"

Sources:

- <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/35438660/>
- <https://miketnelson.com/podcast/minimalist-strength-training-zach-moore-3xx>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- **Nordic hamstring scoping review** (Tedeschi et al., J Back Musculoskelet Rehabil 2026): reports up to 60% reduction in new hamstring injuries and up to 85% in recurrences. Strong numbers, held because the hamstring family ran 2026-07-28 and 2026-07-29.
- **Track and field injury prevention meta-analysis** (BMC Sports Sci Med Rehabil 2026;18:49): same mechanism family as Draft A, would be the sport-specific follow-up for a lacrosse or track audience.
- **Advanced resistance training systems vs. straight sets** (J Funct Morphol Kinesiol 2026;11(1):80): drop sets, supersets, cluster sets against plain progressive loading. Perfect companion piece to Draft B. MDPI blocked the fetch today (403), so retry through a mirror before drafting it.

Sources scanned today

- **Newsletter digest**

(newsletter_digest_2026-08-05.pdf): 2 sources. Dr. Mercola send was pure promo (supplement adherence teaser, product blocks) and was skipped. Mike T. Nelson's newsletter carried the full transcript of episode 398 with Zach Moore, "Getting Back to Nutrition Basics". The program-hopping and optimization-culture segment (timestamps 19:56 and 09:54) became the seed for Draft B.

- **PubMed / PMC sweeps:** youth and adolescent injury prevention RCTs, in-season resistance training for football, resisted sprint training, adolescent sleep. Surfaced the Frontiers in Pediatrics multicomponent prevention meta-analysis (16 RCTs, n=16,029). That became Draft A.

- **J Strength Cond Res:** Kassiano et al. systematic review on exercise variation vs. fixed exercise selection (8 studies, N=241). Used as the research anchor under Draft B's hot take.

- **BJSM / JOSPT / Sports Health sweeps:**
Nordic hamstring scoping review (Tedeschi 2026) surfaced but the hamstring family already ran 2026-07-28 and 2026-07-29. Held.
- **Track and field injury prevention meta-analysis** (BMC Sports Sci Med Rehabil 2026): overlapping mechanism with Draft A, held as runner-up.
- **ACSM 2026 resistance training guidance** (secondary coverage only, no primary document reachable): consistent with Draft B's direction, cited nowhere since the primary was not verified.
- **Blocked / unreachable:** mdpi.com returned HTTP 403 on the advanced-training-systems meta-analysis (J Funct Morphol Kinesiol 11(1):80); dropped rather than cited unread. ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc redirects to pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov and was recovered there.